DOUBLE ISSUE

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TIME

THE 100 MOST INFLUENTIAL PEOPLE

JOHN LEGEND

by Harry Belafonte

ELIZABETH WARREN by Kamala Harris
SIMONE BILES by Leslie Jones
VLADIMIR PUTIN by Mikhail Gorbachev
RYAN REYNOLDS by Helen Mirren
EVAN SPIEGEL by DJ Khaled

TIME Magazine

[May 1st, 2017]

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Articles

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The 100 Most Influential People in the World 2017

Gibbs, a former writer and editor in chief at TIME, is the director of the Shorenstein Center and the visiting Edward R. Murrow professor at Harvard Kennedy School. She is the co-author, along with Michael Duffy, of two best-selling presidential histories: *The President's Club: Inside the World's Most Exclusive Fraternity* and *The Preacher and the Presidents: Billy Graham in the White House*.

Our annual list of the 100 Most Influential People explores the intersection of accomplishment and renown. As in years past, this year's list includes Presidents and Prime Ministers, CEOs and celebrities — but they are joined by others of less fame but great force, in the power of their inventions, the scale of their ambitions, the genius of their solutions to problems that no one before them could solve.

Some years the list has the feel of a loose, lively dinner party, people who mostly don't know one another but would get along if they did. This year is a bit more complicated. These past 12 months have sharpened our edges as political debates in the U.S. and

Europe, the Middle East and Asia, turned jagged and primal and seem almost perfectly designed to divide us more deeply. The list includes active opponents—not only U.S. President Donald Trump and North Korea's leader Kim Jong Un but also the Philippines' President Rodrigo Duterte and his nemesis Senator Leila de Lima, whose denunciation of Duterte's bloody crusade against drug dealers has landed her in prison. And there are several people on the list whose influence is the subject of heated debate, from WikiLeaks founder Julian Assange to FBI Director James Comey to White House adviser Stephen Bannon. Each has champions and critics; all are shaping the course of this turbulent year.

In divisive times, it's tempting to nestle in a comfort zone, surrounded by people who look like us, think like us, pray like us, vote like us. Yet many of the men and women on this year's list are calling us out, using the technologies that connect us to expand how we see the world. The youngest, Gavin Grimm, 17, took the risk of speaking out about the most impossibly personal subject — what bathrooms we use — in order to assert the rights of transgender people all the way to the Supreme Court. Meanwhile, the oldest, former Justice Sandra Day O'Connor, 87, used her platform to create a new one, iCivics, to teach students to become active citizens; it reaches half of all middle school social-studies classrooms in the country.

Every year new themes emerge. This year, I am struck by how many people on the list — from Kaiser Permanente CEO Bernard J. Tyson to singer Demi Lovato to Broadway star Ben Platt — have made mental health a special focus of their work. Likewise, the ongoing refugee crisis has inspired heroic efforts by everyone from Raed Saleh, leader of the Syrian White Helmets, to Chobani CEO Hamdi Ulukaya, founder of the Tent initiative, to actor Riz Ahmed and singer Alicia Keys.

Some challenges are best explained by those who have shared them, so we asked Chicago Mayor Rahm Emanuel, chief of staff to

President Obama, to write about Trump's chief, Reince Priebus. New Zealand Prime Minister Bill English writes on British PM Theresa May; and a former U.S. Defense Secretary, Robert Gates, writes about current Defense Secretary James Mattis.

In making the list, we seek counsel from the TIME 100 alumni, many of whom contributed to this issue. Common writes on Chance the Rapper, who was inspired by a phone message Common left him long ago. Tina Fey offers a tribute to Donald Glover; Meryl Streep to Viola Davis; and Sheryl Sandberg to Melinda Gates. In a typical TIME 100 chain reaction, author Colson Whitehead is on the list for his Pulitzer Prize–winning novel, *The Underground Railroad*, which is being adapted for TV by *Moonlight* director Barry Jenkins, who is both on the list and author of the profile of filmmaker Jordan Peele.

This issue was designed by Carrie Gee, with photo direction by Tara Johnson. Miles Aldridge shot the five cover portraits. The project was overseen for the first time by assistant managing editor Dan Macsai. "It's not every day you're working with writers like Taylor Swift, Tim Cook and Mikhail Gorbachev," he says. "But that's what's so great about the TIME 100. It's not just a list of the world's most influential people — it's a conversation among them."

Watch 'The It List: Time's The 100 Most Influential People' available now on People/Entertainment Weekly Network (PEN). Go to PEOPLE.com/PEN, or download the PEN app on streaming devices.

Pioneers

Barbara Lynch by Padma Lakshmi
Bob Ferguson by George Takei
Celina Turchi by Tom Frieden
Chance The Rapper by Common

Conor McGregor by Arnold Schwarzenegger
Constance Wu by Lena Dunham
Demis Hassabis by Ray Kurzweil
Gavin Grimm by Janet Mock
Glenda Gray by Alice Park
Guus Velders by Leonardo DiCaprio
Hamdi Ulukaya by Kenneth Roth
Ivanka Trump by Wendi Murdoch
Jared Kushner by Henry Kissinger
Jordan Peele by Barry Jenkins
Kirsten Green by Emily Weiss
Natalie Batalha, Guillem Anglada-Escudé and Michaël Gillon by Alan Stern
Riz Ahmed by Lin-Manuel Miranda
Samantha Bee by Jane Curtin
Tamika Mallory, Bob Bland, Carmen Perez and Linda Sarsour by Kirsten Gillibrand
Yuriko Koike by Anne Hidalgo

Artists

Alessandro Michele by Jared Leto
Alicia Keys by Kerry Washington
Ava DuVernay by Venus Williams
Barry Jenkins by Kathryn Bigelow
Ben Platt by Zac Efron
Colson Whitehead by Oprah Winfrey
Demi Lovato by Arianna Huffington
Donald Glover by Tina Fey
Ed Sheeran by Taylor Swift
Emma Stone by Brie Larson
James Corden by Elton John
John Legend by Harry Belafonte
Kerry James Marshall by Grant Hill
Leslie Jones by Russell Crowe

Margot Robbie by Martin Scorsese
Ryan Reynolds by Helen Mirren
Sarah Paulson by Cate Blanchett

Titans

Bernard J. Tyson by John Lewis
Daniel Ek by Ed Sheeran
Evan Spiegel by DJ Khaled
George Church by Stephen Colbert
James Allison by Siobhan O'Connor
Janet Yellen by Joseph Stiglitz
Jason Blum by Harvey Weinstein
Jean Liu by Tim Cook
Jeff Bezos by Buzz Aldrin
LeBron James by Rita Dove
Margrethe Vestager by Helle Thorning-Schmidt
Rebekah Mercer by Ted Cruz
Tom Brady by Conan O'Brien
Vijay Shekhar Sharma by Nandan Nilekani

Leaders

Chuck Schumer by Harry Reid
Donald Trump by Paul Ryan
Elizabeth Warren by Kamala Harris
General James Mattis by Robert Gates
James Comey by John McCain
Juan Manuel Santos by Ingrid Betancourt
Julian Assange by Jack Goldsmith
Kim Jong Un by Christopher Hill
King Maha Vajiralongkorn by Charlie Campbell
Melinda Gates by Sheryl Sandberg
Narendra Modi by Pankaj Mishra
Pope Francis by Cardinal Blase J. Cupich

Major General Qasem Soleimani by Kenneth M. Pollack
Recep Tayyip Erdogan by Can Dundar
Reince Priebus by Rahm Emanuel
Rodrigo Duterte by Cesar Gaviria
Sandra Day O'Connor by Sonia Sotomayor
Stephen Bannon by Michael Duffy
Theo Epstein by John Cusack
Theresa May by Bill English
Tom Perez by Tim Kaine
Vladimir Putin by Mikhail Gorbachev
Wang Qishan by Zoher Abdoolcarim
Xi Jinping by John Kerry

Icons

Ashley Graham by Tyra Banks
Biram Dah Abeid by Aidan McQuade
Cindy Arlette Contreras Bautista by Susanna Schrobsdorff
Cindy Sherman by Miranda July
Colin Kaepernick by Jim Harbaugh
David Adjaye by Thelma Golden
Fan Bingbing by Diane von Furstenberg
Fatou Bensouda by Aryn Baker
Gretchen Carlson by Katie Couric
Jeanette Vizguerra by America Ferrera
John Lewis by Cory Booker
Leila De Lima by Samantha Power
Margaret Atwood by Ann Patchett
Neymar by David Beckham
Raed Saleh by Mustafa Abu Faisal
Raf Simons by A$AP Rocky
RuPaul by Naomi Campbell
Simone Biles by Leslie Jones
Thelma Aldana by José Ugaz
Viola Davis by Meryl Streep

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The 2018 TIME 100

Although I helped come up with the idea for the TIME 100 (along with the slightly less popular Get 100 Famous People to Draw Turkey Hands for Thanksgiving), the editors of this magazine have never let me sit in on one single TIME 100 meeting, ever. This is likely due to a deep-seated prejudice against having someone interrupt every debate over a world leader's relative influence with "Let's ask him for a turkey hand!"

So I've moved on to a more important task: guessing next year's TIME 100. TIME, after all, can use its global reporting team and well-connected, handsome essayists to find the influencers bubbling toward the top for next year.

At first, trying to guess the 2018 TIME 100 was hard, since not only has 2018 not happened, but I haven't been paying much attention to 2017. I started my list (which you can read at time.com/Joel2018) by jotting down the obvious, like Anthony

Weiner, who is definitely not done messing stuff up with selfies of his private parts. Also, Bernd Lembcke, the managing director of Mar-a-Lago, who will decide which diners get to see secret intelligence reports, some of which involve the whereabouts of the vowels in his name. Jared Kushner is on the list because he will be the richest person in the world, depending on the exchange rate of the ruble. I included Tim Ferriss because once the idea of being on the TIME 100 is in his head, I know he will do anything to accomplish this goal–as long as it doesn't take more than four hours a week.

The Leaders section was even easier, since it's always the same: the Pope, Xi Jinping, Vladimir Putin, Kim Jong Un, Recep Tayyip Erdogan and Narendra Modi. The President of the United States is on the list without fail, so for 2018 I wrote Mike Pence. Scotland's First Minister Nicola Sturgeon got on, since putting the final nail in the coffin of the British Empire has got to be influential. I put down King Charles of England because that's got to happen eventually, right? Majority whip Steve Scalise will also be influential in 2018, since it will be the year he finds out there's a calculator function on his smartphone that he can use to count votes.

The first person I put down under Icons was Frederick Douglass, because he is an example of somebody who's done an amazing job and is being recognized more and more, I notice. Also on the list are Beyoncé's twins, who–based on a formula that takes Suri Cruise, multiplies her by two and squares it by Beyoncé–will be the most covered celebrities on earth.

For Titans, I included Vivek Sankaran, the president of Frito-Lay, since California voted to legalize marijuana. The list almost always has one or two chefs on it. This is because TIME editors travel and need reservations, so I chose the wildly innovative, brilliant chef Massimo Bottura and the wildly innovative, brilliant chef Daniel Humm, since I travel and need reservations.

In the Artists section, I threw on Yue Minjun, since Chinese art is not only a thing, but the kind of thing TIME editors can't resist saying they know about. Also Michael Chabon, since TIME editors think people still read novels.

The Pioneers section is by far the hardest, since it includes people who actually do things. I did a search for Harvard scientists and had to scroll through, like, 11 professors until I got to someone who had never been in the TIME 100 and wasn't dead. Which is how I came up with Melissa Franklin, who better figure out something new about the quark in the next 12 months.

So use my 100 picks for 2018's influencers to argue with your friends or as a guest list to a swanky party with major corporate sponsors. Only if you do, please invite me. Not everyone does. I promise not to talk about turkey hands this time.

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Name Game

Olivia B. Waxman is a staff writer at TIME. She covers history and education.

A. Julian Assange

B. Melinda Gates

C. Ivanka Trump

D. Ed Sheeran

E. Simone Biles

F. Gretchen Carlson

G. RuPaul

H. Margot Robbie

I. Emma Stone

J. Jeff Bezos

K. Margaret Atwood

L. Xi Jinping

M. Tom Brady

N. Chuck Schumer

O. Demi Lovato

P. Pope Francis

Q. Theresa May

R. James Corden

S. Alicia Keys

T. Donald Glover

1. GOT A PERFECT 1600 SAT SCORE

_____

2. ONCE WORKED AS A BAR BOUNCER

_____

3. WAS IN TWO BOY BANDS

_____

4. CAN FIT 47 MALTED MILK BALLS IN HIS MOUTH

_____

5. IDOLIZES JUDGE JUDY

_____

6. ONCE HAD A PET RAT

_____

7. USED TO COMPETE IN WRESTLING MATCHES WITH FARMERS

_____

8. ATTENDED THE SAME HIGH SCHOOL AS BARRY BONDS

_____

9. WAS REPORTEDLY OFFERED A SPOT ON ABC’S THE BACHELORETTE

_____

10. APPEARED ON THE COSBY SHOW

_____

11. LIVED ON AN ABANDONED PINEAPPLE FARM

_____

12. LOVES TO GO BIRD-WATCHING

_____

13. COLLECTS TURTLES

_____

14. TOOK APART HIS OWN CRIB WITH A SCREWDRIVER WHEN HE WAS 3 YEARS OLD

_____

15. HAS A GEOGRAPHY DEGREE

_____

16. WAS BORN ON AN AIR FORCE BASE

_____

17. HAD HER SWEET 16 AT APPLEBEE’S

_____

18. WAS HEAD OF HER HIGH SCHOOL DRILL TEAM

_____

19. HAD BRACES FOR SEVEN YEARS

_____

20. CAN JUMP ROPE FOR 30 MINUTES STRAIGHT

_____

ANSWERS: 1. N; 2. P; 3. R; 4. D; 5. G; 6. H; 7. L; 8. M; 9. C; 10. S; 11. A; 12. K; 13. E; 14. J; 15. Q; 16. T; 17. O; 18. B; 19. I; 20. F

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Influencing the Influential

1. Viola Davis discusses how having grown up in poverty has affected her life in Hollywood.

2. RuPaul explains why not to take life too seriously.

3. Riz Ahmed reveals the benefits of sticking around even when you feel you don’t belong.

4. John Legend talks about the intersection of art and activism.

5. Gavin Grimm describes what it’s like to have your private life inspire a public conversation.

People Entertainment WEEKLY NETWORK

To celebrate the release of the TIME 100, the People/Entertainment Weekly Network is releasing “The It List: The 100 Most Influential People,” a special episode featuring interviews with members of the TIME 100, as well as TIME writers and editors who discuss their selections. To watch, go to people.com/PEN or download the PEN app.

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Points of Origin

[The following text appears within a map. Please see hardcopy or PDF for actual map.]

[LEADERS]

CHUCK SCHUMER

Brooklyn

[PIONEERS]

KIRSTEN GREEN

Vandenberg AFB, Calif.

[ICONS]

RUPAUL

San Diego

[TITANS]

BERNARD J. TYSON

Vallejo, Calif.

[ARTISTS]

EMMA STONE

Scottsdale, Ariz.

[TITANS]

JEFF BEZOS

Albuquerque, N.M.

[PIONEERS]

BOB FERGUSON

Seattle

[ARTISTS]

BEN PLATT

Los Angeles

[ARTISTS]

RYAN REYNOLDS

Vancouver

[PIONEERS]

NATALIE BATALHA

Oakland, Calif.

[ARTISTS]

DONALD GLOVER

Edwards AFB, Calif.

[ARTISTS]

AVA DUVERNAY

Long Beach, Calif.

[ICONS]

SIMONE BILES

Columbus, Ohio

[TITANS]

EVAN SPIEGEL

Los Angeles

[PIONEERS]

CARMEN PEREZ

Oxnard, Calif.

[ARTISTS]

DEMI LOVATO

Albuquerque, N.M.

[TITANS]

TOM BRADY

San Mateo, Calif.

[ARTISTS]

COLSON WHITEHEAD

New York City

[LEADERS]

GENERAL JAMES MATTIS

Pullman, Wash.

[TITANS]

JASON BLUM

Los Angeles

[LEADERS]

ELIZABETH WARREN

Oklahoma City

[LEADERS]

SANDRA DAY O’CONNOR

El Paso, Texas

[ICONS]

JOHN LEGEND

Springfield, Ohio

[ARTISTS]

ALICIA KEYS

New York City

[LEADERS]

MELINDA GATES

Dallas

[PIONEERS]

CHANCE THE RAPPER

Chicago

[ICONS]

ASHLEY GRAHAM

Lincoln, Neb.

[TITANS]

JAMES ALLISON

Alice, Texas

[ICONS]

JEANETTE VIZGUERRA

Mexico City

[PIONEERS]

IVANKA TRUMP

New York City

[TITANS]

LEBRON JAMES

Akron, Ohio

[ICONS]

CINDY ARLETTE CONTRERAS BAUTISTA

Ayacucho, Peru

[ICONS]

GRETCHEN CARLSON

Anoka, Minn.

[ARTISTS]

LESLIE JONES

Memphis

[ICONS]

THELMA ALDANA

Zacapa, Guatemala

[ICONS]

COLIN KAEPERNICK

Milwaukee

[LEADERS]

JUAN MANUEL SANTOS

Bogotá

[PIONEERS]

SAMANTHA BEE

Toronto

[LEADERS]

DONALD TRUMP

Queens, N.Y.

[ICONS]

JOHN LEWIS

Troy, Ala.

[LEADERS]

TOM PEREZ

Buffalo, N.Y.

[ICONS]

VIOLA DAVIS

St. Matthews, S.C.

[ICONS]

MARGARET ATWOOD

Ottawa

[PIONEERS]

TAMIKA MALLORY

New York City

[LEADERS]

LINDA SARSOUR

Brooklyn

[ARTISTS]

KERRY JAMES MARSHALL

Birmingham, Ala.

[PIONEERS]

CELINA TURCHI

Goiânia, Brazil

[LEADERS]

THEO EPSTEIN

New York City

[TITANS]

JANET YELLEN

Brooklyn

[TITANS]

REBEKAH MERCER

Tarrytown, N.Y.

[LEADERS]

POPE FRANCIS

Buenos Aires

[ICONS]

NEYMAR

Mogi das Cruzes, Brazil

[PIONEERS]

BOB BLAND

Fairfax, Va.

[PIONEERS]

BARBARA LYNCH

Boston

[LEADERS]

REINCE PRIEBUS

Dover, N.J.

[PIONEERS]

CONSTANCE WU

Richmond, Va.

[PIONEERS]

JARED KUSHNER

Livingston, N.J.

[ICONS]

CINDY SHERMAN

Glen Ridge, N.J.

[PIONEERS]

JORDAN PEELE

New York City

[PIONEERS]

GAVIN GRIMM

Newport News, Va.

[LEADERS]

STEPHEN BANNON

Norfolk, Va.

[ICONS]

BIRAM DAH ABEID

Jidrel Mohguen, Mauritania

[PIONEERS]

CONOR MCGREGOR

Dublin

[ARTISTS]

BARRY JENKINS

Miami

[TITANS]

GEORGE CHURCH

MacDill AFB, Fla.

[ARTISTS]

ED SHEERAN

Halifax, England

[PIONEERS]

MICHAËL GILLON

Liège, Belgium

[ARTISTS]

SARAH PAULSON

Tampa

[PIONEERS]

DEMIS HASSABIS

London

[LEADERS]

JAMES COMEY

Yonkers, N.Y.

[ICONS]

FATOU BENSOUDA

Banjul, Gambia

[PIONEERS]

GUILLEM ANGLADA-ESCUDÉ

Terrassa, Spain

[LEADERS]

THERESA MAY

Eastbourne, England

[PIONEERS]

GUUS VELDERS

Tiel, The Netherlands

[LEADERS]

RECEP TAYYIP ERDOGAN

Istanbul

[ARTISTS]

ALESSANDRO MICHELE

Rome

[ICONS]

RAF SIMONS

Neerpelt, Belgium

[ARTISTS]

JAMES CORDEN

London

[PIONEERS]

GLENDA GRAY

Boksburg, South Africa

[TITANS]

DANIEL EK

Stockholm

[ICONS]

RAED SALEH

Jisr al-Shughur, Syria

[PIONEERS]

HAMDI ULUKAYA

Ilic, Turkey

[ICONS]

DAVID ADJAYE

Dar es Salaam, Tanzania

[PIONEERS]

RIZ AHMED

London

[TITANS]

MARGRETHE VESTAGER

Glostrup, Denmark

[LEADERS]

MAJOR GENERAL QASEM SOLEIMANI

Qante-e Malek, Iran

[LEADERS]

VLADIMIR PUTIN

St. Petersburg

[LEADERS]

NARENDRA MODI

Vadnagar, India

[TITANS]

VIJAY SHEKHAR SHARMA

Aligarh, India

[LEADERS]

KING MAHA VAJIRALONGKORN

Bangkok

[LEADERS]

WANG QISHAN

Qingdao, China

[ICONS]

FAN BINGBING

Qingdao, China

[ICONS]

LEILA DE LIMA

Iriga City, Philippines

[LEADERS]

JULIAN ASSANGE

Townsville, Australia

[LEADERS]

KIM JONG UN

Pyongyang

[LEADERS]

RODRIGO DUTERTE

Maasin, Phillippines

[ARTISTS]

MARGOT ROBBIE

Dalby, Australia

[PIONEERS]

YURIKO KOIKE

Ashiya, Japan

[LEADERS]

XI JINPING

Beijing

[TITANS]

JEAN LIU

Beijing

TITANS

LEADERS

ICONS

ARTISTS

PIONEERS

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